



‘BAZBALL’ DOES NOT SUCCEED EVERYWHERE. ONLY WHEN WICKETS ARE FLAT, THE OUTFIELD IS QUICK, AND CONDITIONS ARE IN YOUR FAVOUR CAN THAT CONCEPT WORK, BUT NOT ALWAYS

One of a kind: Muttiah Muralitharan, an unparalleled match-winner, was conferred with Sportstar's first-ever International Icon Award at the Sportstar Aces Awards function in Mumbai. EMMANUAL YOGINI

wicket-taker in Tests and ODIs, Muralitharan has immersed himself in his family business and taken on brief coaching stints. Despite his current focus on balance sheets and consignments, he remains a dedicated follower of the game.

“Tell me what you want to know,” he says with a broad smile. And we get going...

In recent years, there have been debates over the evolving nature of pitches in the subcontinent.

What is your assessment of this issue?

The wickets have not changed. It's very difficult to bowl in the subcontinent, as the surfaces often favour the spinners more than the fast bowlers. However, if you are a good fast bowler, you get a chance to reverse swing as the ball gets older. But it is a challenge, for sure.

In the 1990s, when I played, India had some really good spinners, so they would make spin-friendly wickets here. But in other parts of



CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- * **Leading wicket-taker** in both Tests and ODIs
- * **One of only two players** to tally over a 1000 wickets in international cricket
- * **Part of Sri Lanka's** World Cup-winning side in 1996
- * **First Sri Lankan** in ICC Hall of Fame